

Championing Financial Wellbeing at Workplaces

RAHUL BANERJEE: BUILDING A FINANCIALLY EMPOWERED INDIA

In a country where financial literacy often lags behind aspiration, Rahul Banerjee, Managing Director of PGP Academy, has set a new benchmark for purposeful leadership in financial education. Recognized among India's 40 Under 40 Leaders (2024) and recipient of the ET Young Entrepreneur Award for Innovation in Education (2024), Rahul has built one of India's most admired learning institutions — and in doing so, has elevated an entire ecosystem of financial professionals.

Founded in 2018, PGP Academy has evolved from a bold idea into a national knowledge powerhouse. What began as a specialized training platform has today become the country's leading centre for wealth-management and financial-advisory education, transforming thousands of careers through programs that blend global rigor with Indian relevance.

GLOBAL PARTNERSHIPS, LOCAL PURPOSE

Rahul's vision rests on a single belief — that education must empower action. Under his leadership, PGP Academy has partnered with Moody's Analytics Global Education (Canadian Securities Institute), AIWM Switzerland, and the CFA Institute to bring globally recognized programs such as the Award in International Wealth Management, Certified International Wealth Manager (CIWM), and Investment Foundations Certificate to Indian learners.

What distinguishes the Academy is its ability to contextualize global knowledge — adapting every program to India's market realities, regulatory environment, and investor psychology. The result is a new generation of Indian financial professionals trained not

merely to qualify, but to excel.

EMPOWERING ADVISORS AND EXPANDING HORIZONS

PGP Academy's alumni now include thousands of mutual-fund distributors, wealth managers, and investment advisors who attribute their certification success and career growth to Rahul's ecosystem of structured learning and mentorship.

Initiatives like GROW (Guided Roadmap for Optimal Wealth) and the high-impact Specialized Investment Fund (SIF) training — conducted with The Wealth Company AMC — have enabled professionals to decode complex advisory domains with clarity and confidence.

Rahul also spearheads MFDidi, a transformative initiative empowering women through financial literacy and entrepreneurship. Launched with The Wealth Company AMC, it equips women to become independent Mutual Fund Distributors — blending technical competence with a sense of purpose, community, and empowerment.

The Academy has also conducted structured financial-education programs for leading corporates — including the acclaimed Masterclass in Financial Assets and Masterclass in Portfolio Management and Client Advisory for employees of HDFC Mutual Fund — one of the standout engagements of the past year.

CHAMPIONING FINANCIAL WELLBEING AT WORKPLACES

Recognizing that financial stress is a major cause of employee disengagement, Rahul has extended PGP Academy's expertise into the corporate financial-wellbeing domain. Partnering with leading Indian and multinational firms, he designs



structured learning interventions that help employees understand money better — from budgeting and risk appetite and behavioural finance to goal-based investing and retirement readiness.

"Financial wellbeing is not a perk; it's a pillar of overall wellbeing," Rahul often says — a sentiment that defines his philosophy.

LEADERSHIP ROOTED IN VISION AND VALUES

An alumnus of IIM Calcutta and a double-certified professional — Certified Financial Planner (CFP) and Certified International Wealth Manager (CIWM) — Rahul blends academic excellence with deep industry insight. As a jury member for the CNBC-TV18 Financial Advisor Awards and The Life Goal Advisor Awards, he continues to shape India's standards of financial excellence.

Today, as a member of the National BFSI Committees of both the Indian Chamber of Commerce (ICC) and the Bengal Chamber of Commerce & Industry (BCC&I), he contributes actively to advancing India's financial-literacy and wealth creation agenda.

Grounded in purpose, driven by innovation, and guided by empathy, Rahul Banerjee's journey embodies the spirit of a Most Admired CEO — one who is not merely building a business, but a financially stronger nation.